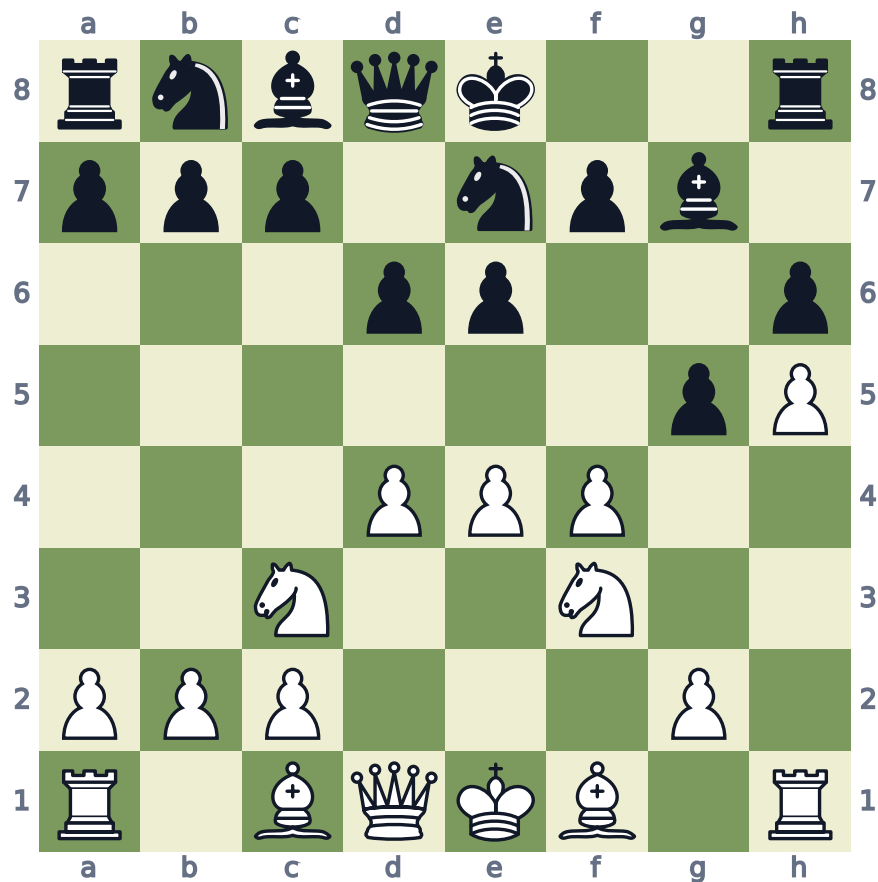


Fighting Anti-Hippo Space Attacks

h-pawn storms, five-pawn centers, early e5 and d5, long castling, and emergency exits



Defend the positions opponents use to try to refute the Hippo, with concrete break timing and clear signals for leaving the standard setup.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Defend the positions opponents use to try to refute the Hippo, with concrete break timing and clear signals for leaving the standard setup.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected Black core repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Space is dangerous when it supports a pawn break before Black is coordinated.

PRINCIPLE 2

Meet a wing attack in the center whenever the calculation works.

PRINCIPLE 3

Closing the kingside can be useful, but only if it does not bury the g7 bishop forever.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

A five-pawn center contains targets as well as territory.

PRINCIPLE 5

Long castling changes b5 from expansion into a direct attacking tool.

PRINCIPLE 6

When the standard shell cannot meet a threat, the correct Hippo move is the non-Hippo move.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|--|---|
| 01 | Close the h-file attack carefully | Closing a wing buys time; spend it on the center. |
| 02 | Answer g4 with d5 | A wing pawn move is a tempo you may use for central contact. |
| 03 | Emergency reaction to e5 | When e5 cramps both knights, the setup phase is over. |
| 04 | Break the d5 clamp | A space clamp must be undermined at its base, not stared at. |
| 05 | Five-pawn center: strike now | Maximum space creates maximum targets only while the center is still mobile. |
| 06 | Long castle and kingside storm | Against opposite-side intentions, count forcing moves on both wings. |
| 07 | London space clamp with d5 | A quiet system can still create a clamp; react when d5 fixes the chain. |
| 08 | Pawn storm with f5 | When f5 lands, calculate captures and central breaks before continuing the shell. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Close the h-file attack carefully



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. h4 h6 5. f4 e6 6. Nf3 Ne7 7. h5 g5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Block immediate hxg6 ideas and prepare a central counterbreak.

MAIN DANGER

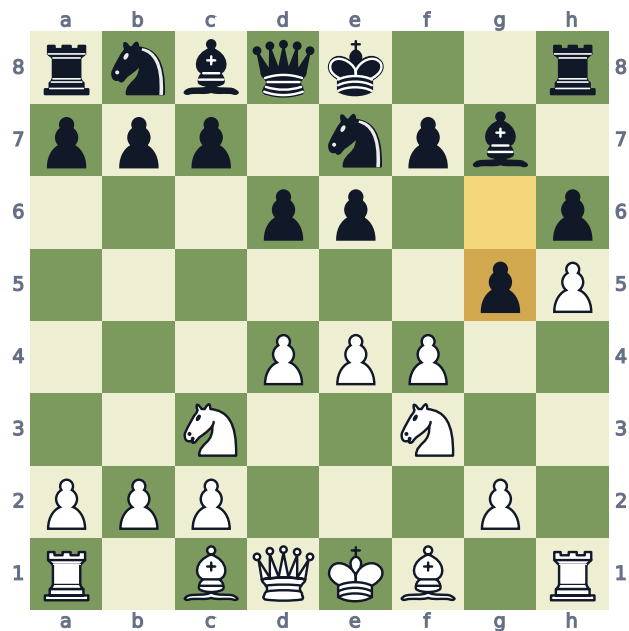
g5 creates permanent dark-square holes and may be undermined by e5.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Closing a wing buys time; spend it on the center.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +2.97 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. fxg5 Ng8 2. Be3 Nc6 3. Qd2 hxg5 4. Bxg5 f6 5. Be3 Nh6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Close the h-file attack carefully



YOUR TASK

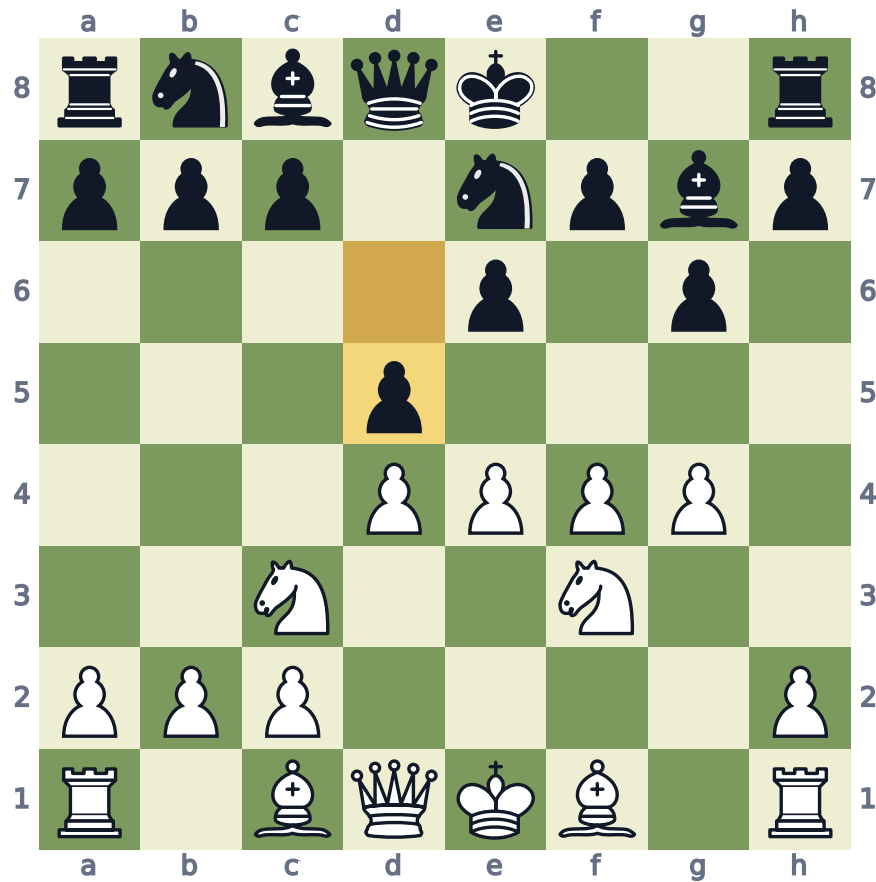
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Answer g4 with d5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. g4 d5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Open the center while White's king and pieces lag behind the pawn storm.

MAIN DANGER

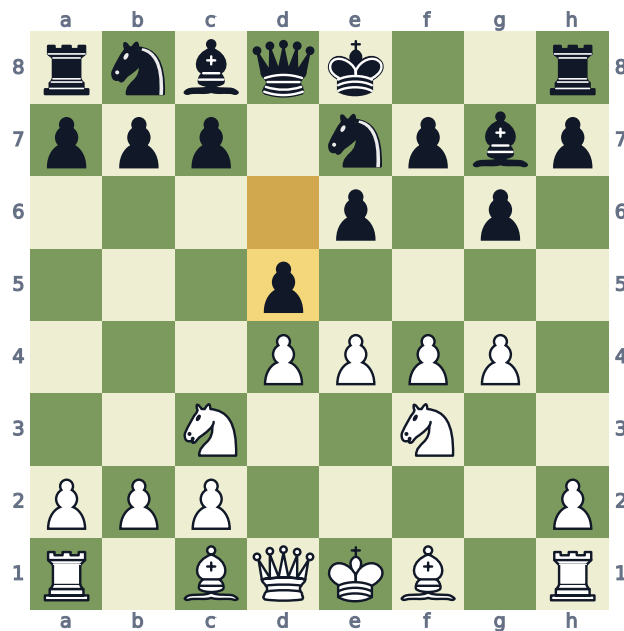
e5 can close the position and maintain the space advantage.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A wing pawn move is a tempo you may use for central contact.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.83 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 h5 2. gxh5 Rxh5 3. h4 Bd7 4. Bd3 Nbc6 5. Bd2 Nb4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Answer g4 with d5



YOUR TASK

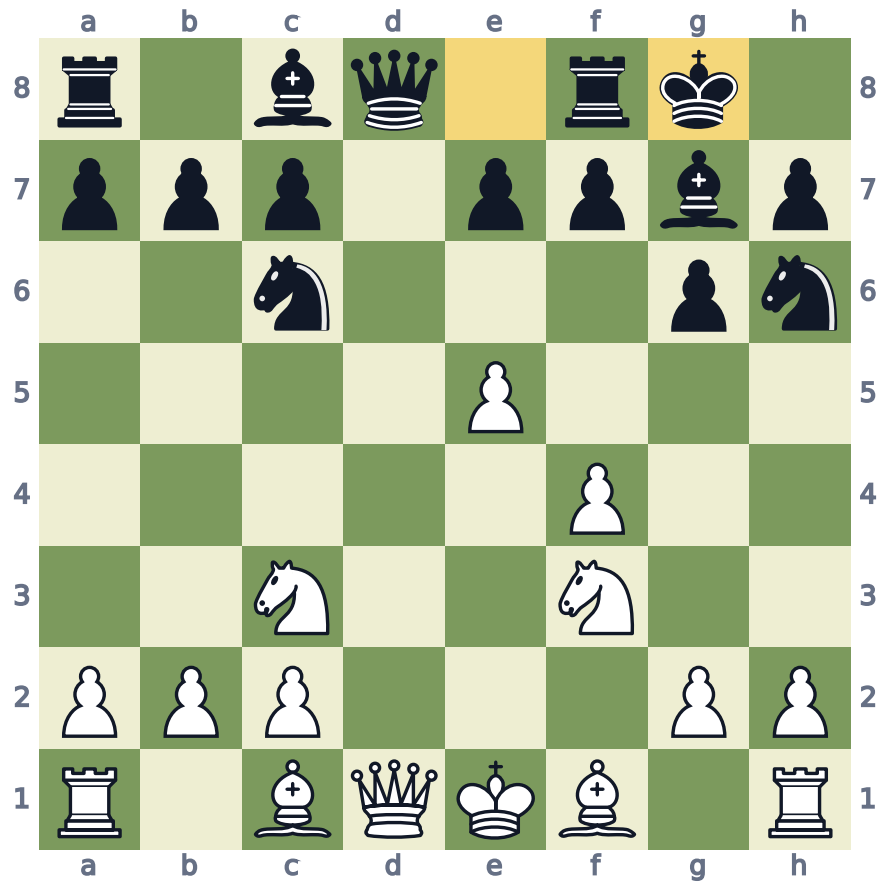
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Emergency reaction to e5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e5 dxe5 5. dxe5 Nc6 6. f4 Nh6 7. Nf3 O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack or exchange the advanced pawn before it freezes the shell.

MAIN DANGER

Nxe5 tactics may fail if the knight is pinned or underdefended.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When e5 cramps both knights, the setup phase is over.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.11 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Be3 Bg4 2. Bf2 Qxd1+ 3. Rxd1 Bxf3 4. gxf3 Rfd8 5. Bd3 e6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Emergency reaction to e5



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Break the d5 clamp



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. d5 exd5 6. cxd5 Ne7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Exchange the base and prepare c6 or f5 against White's space.

MAIN DANGER

White's d5 pawn can become protected and restrict c6.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A space clamp must be undermined at its base, not stared at.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.58 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Nf3 Nd7 3. Be3 f5 4. Nd4 Nc5 5. f3 fxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Break the d5 clamp



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Five-pawn center: strike now



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. f4 Ne7 6. g4 d5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Exploit White's delayed development with immediate central contact.

MAIN DANGER

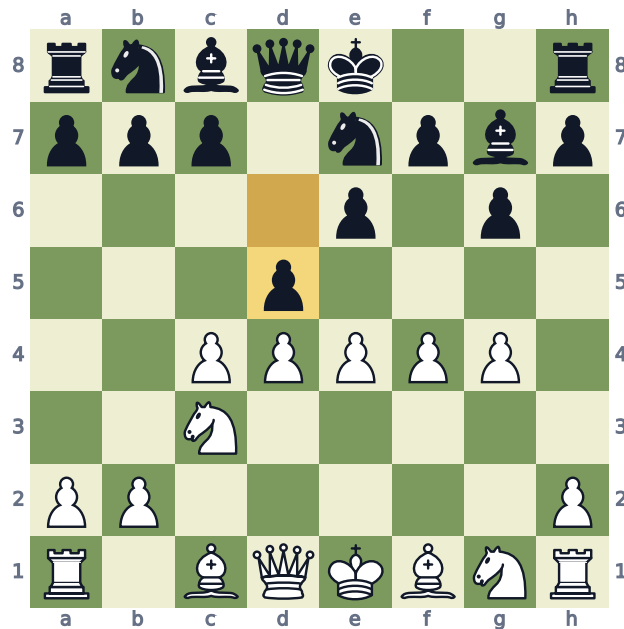
If e5 closes the center, the kingside bind can become dangerous.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Maximum space creates maximum targets only while the center is still mobile.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.04 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. e5 Nbc6 2. Nf3 h5 3. gxh5 Rxh5 4. Be3 Nf5 5. Qd2 dxc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Five-pawn center: strike now



YOUR TASK

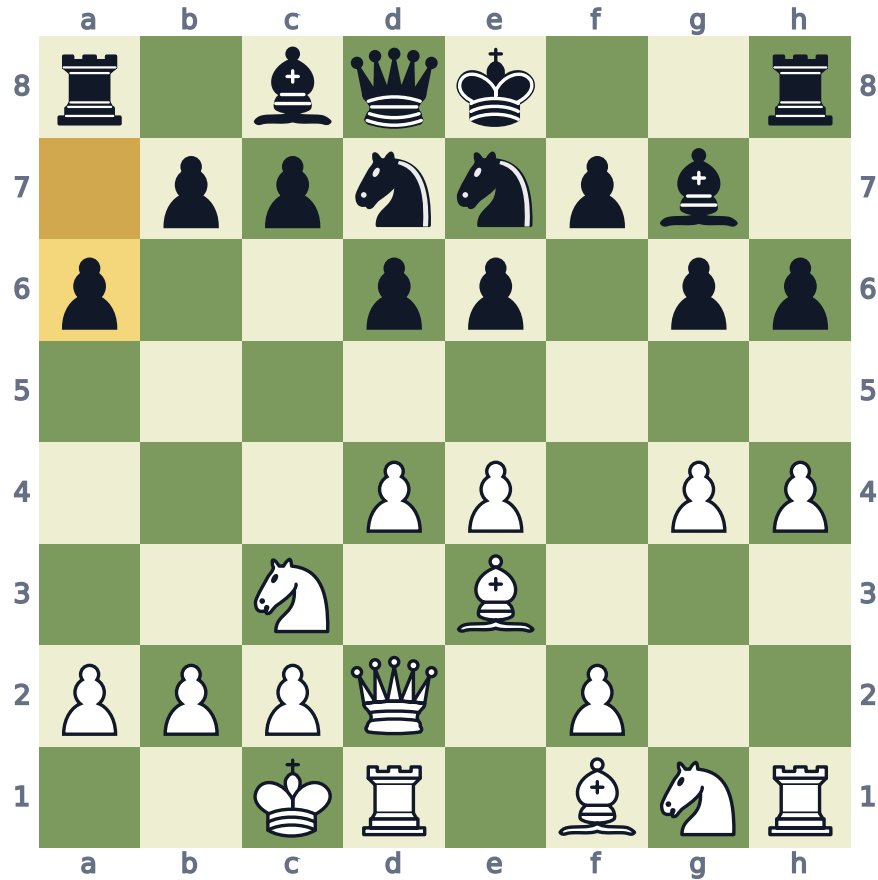
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Long castle and kingside storm



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. Be3 e6 5. Qd2 Ne7 6. O-O-O Nd7 7. h4 h6 8. g4 a6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

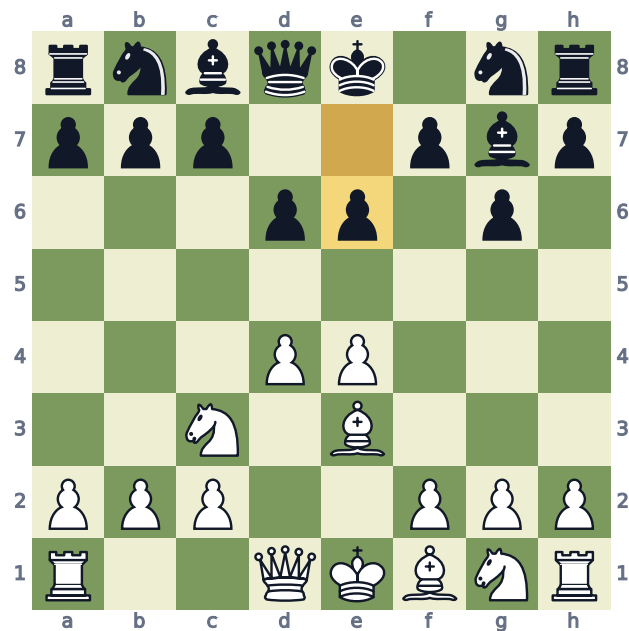
Keep the king uncommitted and prepare b5 while slowing the h-pawn.

MAIN DANGER

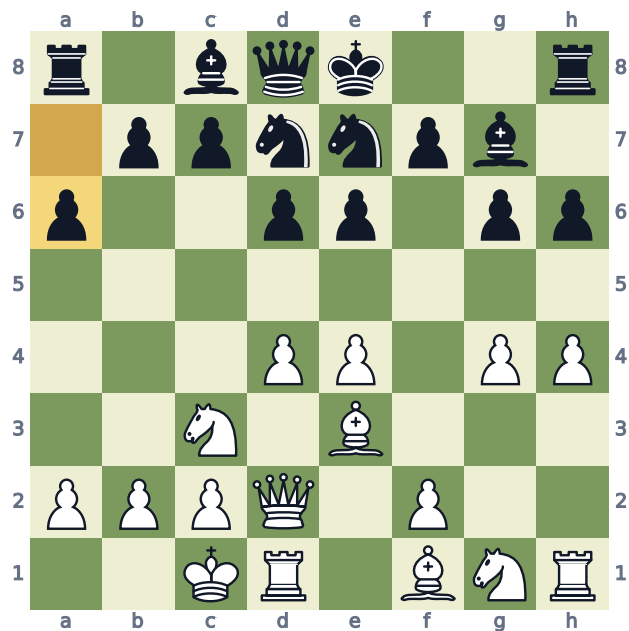
h5 and Bxh6 can open lines before b5 arrives.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against opposite-side intentions, count forcing moves on both wings.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.41 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 g5 2. f4 gxf4 3. Bxf4 e5 4. dxe5 Nxe5 5. g5 hxg5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Long castle and kingside storm



YOUR TASK

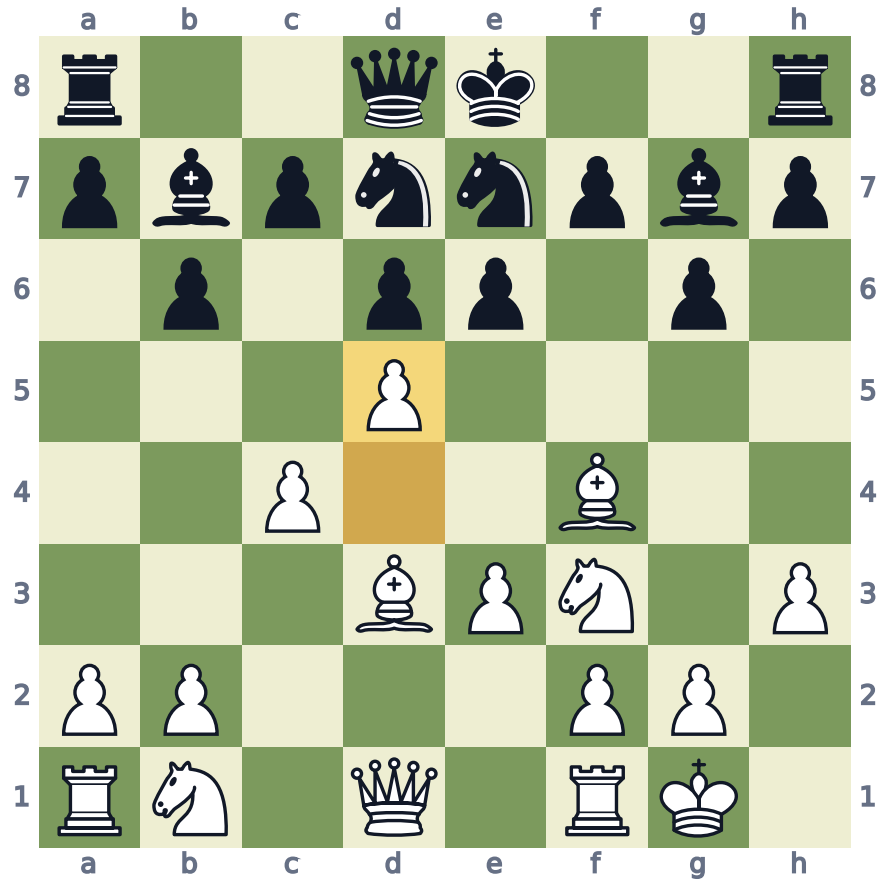
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

London space clamp with d5



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. Nf3 Bg7 3. Bf4 d6 4. e3 e6 5. h3 Ne7 6. Bd3 Nd7 7. O-O b6 8. c4 Bb7 9. d5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

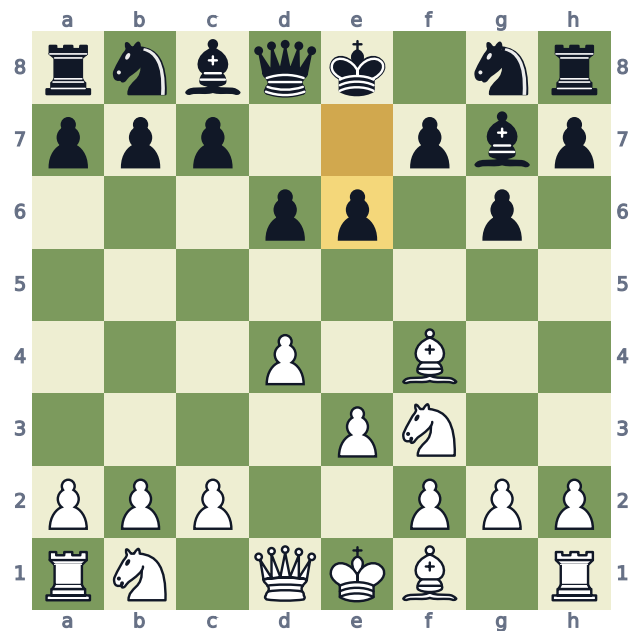
Prepare exd5 or e5 and reorganize before the closed center becomes permanent.

MAIN DANGER

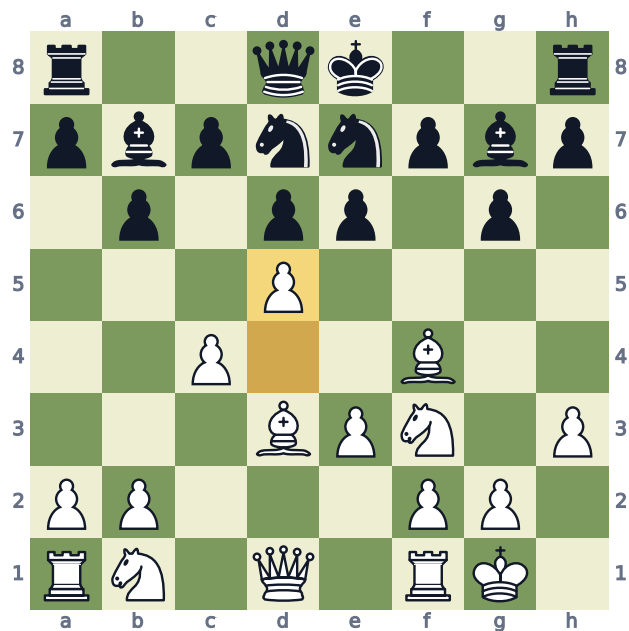
White can support e4 and squeeze the compact knights.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A quiet system can still create a clamp; react when d5 fixes the chain.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.82 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bxb2 Nbd2 2. Nc5 Ne4 3. exd5 cxd5 4. Nxd3 Qxd3 5. Bxa1 Rxa1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

London space clamp with d5



YOUR TASK

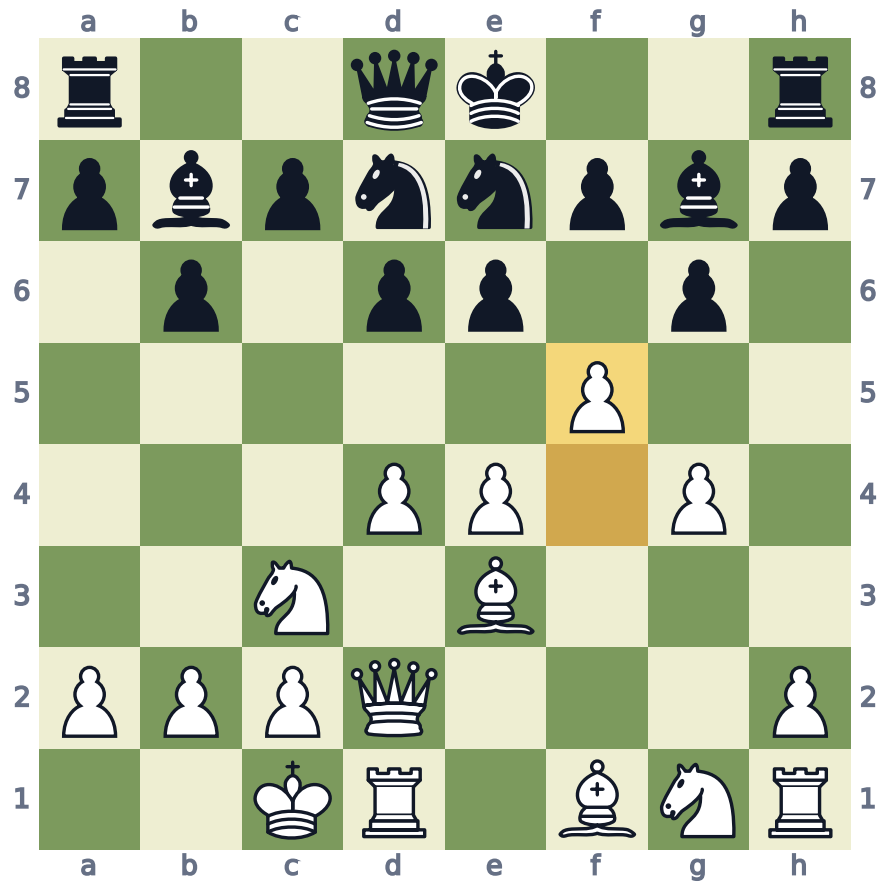
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Pawn storm with f5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 e6 5. Be3 Ne7 6. Qd2 Nd7 7. O-O-O b6 8. g4 Bb7 9. f5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Choose between exf5, e5, or queenside counterplay from calculation.

MAIN DANGER

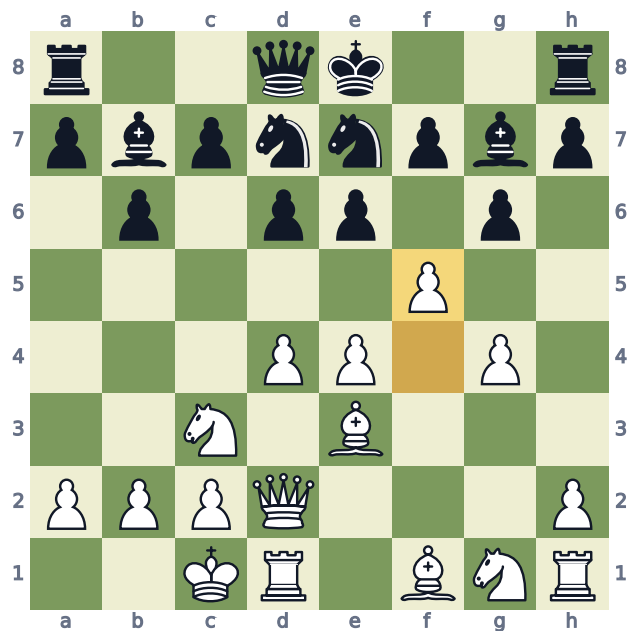
Opening the e- or g-file can expose an uncastled king.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When f5 lands, calculate captures and central breaks before continuing the shell.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

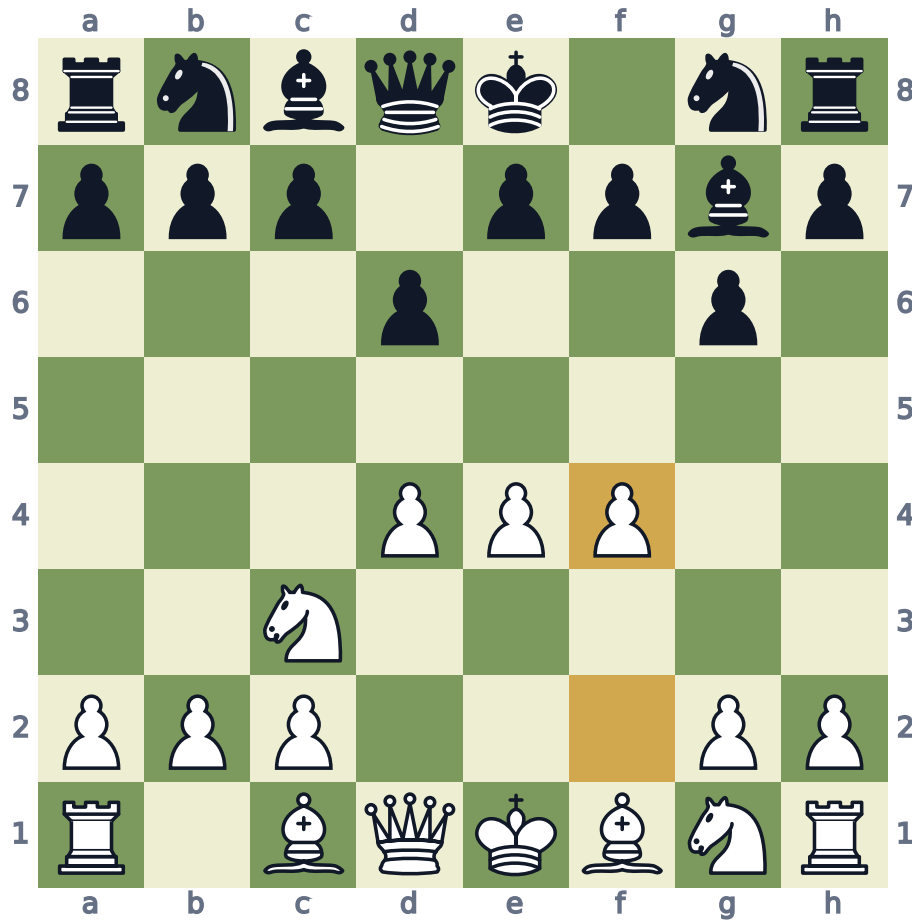
Position estimate: +0.51 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. exf5 gxf5 2. Nxf5 exf5 3. Bxh1 Bg5 4. Nf6 Re1+ 5. Kf8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Pawn storm with f5



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. CLOSE THE H-FILE ATTACK CAREFULLY

Course move: h6. Purpose: Block immediate hxg6 ideas and prepare a central counterbreak. Engine comparison: 1. h5 Be3 2. c6 Qd2 3. b5 f3 4. a5 Bd3 5. Na6 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: g5 creates permanent dark-square holes and may be undermined by e5.

02. ANSWER G4 WITH D5

Course move: d6. Purpose: Open the center while White's king and pieces lag behind the pawn storm. Engine comparison: 1. c6 Nf3 2. d5 e5 3. Bg4 h3 (+0.68 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 can close the position and maintain the space advantage.

03. EMERGENCY REACTION TO E5

Course move: dxe5. Purpose: Attack or exchange the advanced pawn before it freezes the shell. Engine comparison: 1. dxe5 dxe5 2. Qxd1+ Nxd1 3. Bxe5 Nf3 4. Bd6 Ne3 5. Nf6 Nc4 (-1.14 for White (Black is clearly better)). Warning: Nxe5 tactics may fail if the knight is pinned or underdefended.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. BREAK THE D5 CLAMP

Course move: d6. Purpose: Exchange the base and prepare c6 or f5 against White's space. Engine comparison: 1. c5 d5 2. d6 e4 3. Bxc3+ bxc3 4. e5 f4 5. f5 Nf3 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White's d5 pawn can become protected and restrict c6.

05. FIVE-PAWN CENTER: STRIKE NOW

Course move: d6. Purpose: Exploit White's delayed development with immediate central contact. Engine comparison: 1. c5 d5 2. d6 e4 3. Bxc3+ bxc3 4. e5 f4 5. f5 Nf3 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: If e5 closes the center, the kingside bind can become dangerous.

06. LONG CASTLE AND KINGSIDE STORM

Course move: e6. Purpose: Keep the king uncommitted and prepare b5 while slowing the h-pawn. Engine comparison: 1. Nd7 Nf3 2. a6 a4 3. c5 dxc5 4. Nxc5 Bxc5 5. Bxc3+ bxc3 (+0.73 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: h5 and Bxh6 can open lines before b5 arrives.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. LONDON SPACE CLAMP WITH D5

Course move: e6. Purpose: Prepare exd5 or e5 and reorganize before the closed center becomes permanent. Engine comparison: 1. c5 c3 2. cxd4 cxd4 3. Nf6 Nc3 4. Qb6 (+0.09 for White (equal)). Warning: White can support e4 and squeeze the compact knights.

08. PAWN STORM WITH F5

Course move: e6. Purpose: Choose between exf5, e5, or queenside counterplay from calculation. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3 (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Opening the e- or g-file can expose an uncastled king.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.